

Evening Reading - Notes and Margins

Personal | Marine biology, Berry, O'Brian, and what is on the table now

Notes kept from evening reading. Not a book club, just a habit. Written down because a good line is worth keeping and the marina crowd is not the place to talk about it.

Currently on the table

Braiding Sweetgrass, Robin Wall Kimmerer. A scientist who writes about plants the way a fisherman thinks about water - that it is owed something, not just taken from. The chapter on the honorable harvest reads like a code I half-followed on the boats without a name for it: take only what you need, use all of it, give something back. That is the whole argument for the way we farm now, said better than I could say it.

The yearly cycle - O'Brian

Working back through the Aubrey-Maturin novels again, as every year. They hold up because the sea is the same and the friendship is the engine. Maturin the naturalist scribbling in his notebook while Aubrey works the ship is the two halves of a life I recognize. The seamanship is real enough that you can navigate by it.

Berry, kept close

- On the idea that you cannot take care of a place you do not know, and you cannot know it without staying.
- On work as a form of attention rather than a thing to escape.
- On the cost of treating a living system like a machine - which is the whole story of what happened to the bay I fished as a kid.

Why I keep these

Because the reading and the work are the same thing for me, even if I do not say so at the dock. Water chemistry in the morning, a few pages at night, and the same question under both: how do you take a living from a place without using it up.

Personal reading notes. Private. Kept for the lines worth keeping, nothing more.